

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Platform Cyber Security Engineer | Detection Engineering | CrowdStrike | SOAR Automation | MITRE ATT&CK

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Platform Cyber Security Engineer with more than five years of hands-on experience designing, operating, and continuously improving security controls, detection capabilities, and automated response workflows across complex cloud and enterprise environments. I specialise in detection engineering, building high-fidelity detection logic mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, and developing scalable Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation that reduces reliance on manual Security Operations Centre (SOC) processes. I have expert-level capability across CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation Security Information and Event Management (NG-SIEM) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), alongside strong proficiency in Microsoft Sentinel, Kusto Query Language (KQL), and the broader Microsoft Defender suite. I thrive in engineering-led roles where technical rigour, scalable solutions, and real-world attacker behaviour are the primary drivers, and I am eager to bring this approach to a high-performance fintech security team.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Detection Engineering:** High-fidelity detection development aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques; Indicator of Attack (IoA) and Indicator of Compromise (IoC) creation; detection-as-code practices; tuning rules against live adversary behaviour
- **SOAR and Automated Response:** Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps playbooks; SOAR workflow design and optimisation; PowerShell automation; scalable response over manual SOC processes
- **CrowdStrike Falcon Platform:** NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover - Expert level; cross-domain telemetry ingestion; threat hunting and real-time adversary tracking
- **Microsoft Sentinel and KQL:** Enterprise SIEM engineering; KQL analytics rules, workbooks, and threat hunting queries; data connector management; SOAR playbook development
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender; 8,000-user enterprise deployment
- **Cloud and Identity Security:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD); Conditional Access; Zero Trust architecture; cloud security posture management
- **Vulnerability Management and BAS:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to validate control effectiveness
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 Incident Response lifecycle; threat containment and eradication; post-incident review and detection improvement
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+
- **Scripting:** PowerShell; KQL; security automation pipeline development

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Design, operate, and continuously improve security controls, detection capabilities, and automated response workflows across UAL's cloud and hybrid enterprise environment, prioritising scalable engineering solutions over manual SOC processes
- Build high-fidelity detection rules and response automation using CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, mapping all detections to MITRE ATT&CK to ensure coverage of adversary tactics relevant to the sector
- Engineer SOAR automation playbooks that orchestrate automated alert triage, enrichment, and containment workflows, substantially reducing manual analyst workload and improving mean time to respond (MTTR)

- Conduct proactive threat hunting across CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel, identifying attacker dwell and lateral movement indicators not surfaced by automated detection rules
- Tune detection logic in real time against observed threat actor behaviour, using post-incident findings and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) outputs to iteratively improve detection coverage
- Integrate telemetry from Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Mimecast, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), and other security controls into a unified detection platform
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID and Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) Conditional Access policies, feeding identity telemetry into Sentinel for Identity-based detection use cases across the hybrid cloud estate
- Lead vulnerability management using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, correlating vulnerability intelligence with SIEM telemetry to guide risk-based remediation priorities
- Lead incident response activities aligned to NIST 800-61, applying MITRE ATT&CK mapping to accelerate attacker identification and containment during active security events

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Developed and maintained a detection engineering programme in Microsoft Sentinel, writing KQL analytics rules, workbooks, and hunting queries mapped to MITRE ATT&CK to improve adversary coverage across UAL's hybrid environment
- Built and maintained SOAR playbooks to automate incident response workflows, reducing manual intervention for high-volume, lower-complexity security events and accelerating response to critical incidents
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across the endpoint estate, engineering custom Indicator of Attack (IoA) and Indicator of Compromise (IoC) detection policies tuned to the organisation's specific threat profile
- Onboarded Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an 8,000-user Microsoft 365 environment, integrating telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel for unified cross-domain detection
- Authored PowerShell automation scripts to streamline repetitive security engineering tasks, including detection rule deployment, connector health monitoring, and log ingestion validation
- Conducted regular threat hunting exercises using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and KQL in Sentinel, identifying latent threats missed by automated alerts and refining detection rules based on findings
- Administered BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and ensured privileged session telemetry was captured in the SIEM for both detection and audit compliance purposes
- Supported the delivery of Cyber Essentials+ certification, providing detection and monitoring evidence and remediating identified control gaps

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Supported design and implementation of security controls across the SaaS platform infrastructure, contributing to firewall management, endpoint protection, and access control policy development
- Assisted with log collection and security monitoring configuration, establishing baseline alerting for the company's cloud and on-premises systems
- Supported vulnerability identification and remediation workflows, working with engineering teams to apply security patches and configuration hardening in a fast-moving SaaS environment
- Contributed to identity and access management processes including Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) configuration and user account lifecycle management

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built a scalable detection engineering capability at UAL, designing high-fidelity detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM that mapped directly to MITRE ATT&CK, reducing alert noise while improving coverage of real-world adversary tactics
- Engineered SOAR automation playbooks that reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) for common incident types by automating triage, enrichment, and containment, enabling the security team to scale response capacity without increasing headcount

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an 8,000-user estate, creating a unified detection surface that combined endpoint, identity, and cloud signals in a single platform
- Implemented Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to continuously validate the effectiveness of detection controls, using simulation outputs to identify and close detection gaps before adversaries could exploit them
- Led threat hunting exercises across CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel, identifying active attacker activity that bypassed automated alerting and enabling early containment before escalation
- Developed a PowerShell scripting library that automated routine security engineering tasks, improving repeatability of detection deployments and reducing operational overhead across the security team

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)